

nder people.

Genderqueer

Genderqueer is an umbrella term to refer to gender identities that differ from the binary identities of male and female, including gender non-conforming and non-binary identities. People who identify as genderqueer may see themselves as a combination of both male and female, neither male nor female, different genders at different times or as no specific gender at all.

There can be an overlap between genderqueer, gender non-conforming, non-binary, and genderfluid, but they are not interchangeable terms. You should not use these terms to refer to someone unless they have self-identified with the term(s).

Genderqueer, gender non-conforming, non-binary, and genderfluid people may or may not identify as lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender, or queer.

Gender non-conforming (GNC)

Gender non-conforming is an umbrella term for gender identities and expressions that don't conform to typical gender expectations and falls outside of or in between the feminine and masculine binary.

Non-binary

Non-binary refers to gender identities other than the traditional female and male "binary" identities.

Genderfluid

Genderfluid is a gender identity where someone sees themselves as male, female, or non-binary at different times or under different circumstances. Some people like to express different sides of themselves depending on who they are with or where they are.

Transition or transitioning

Gender transition is a process of changing to align more closely with one's gender identity. It is not a one-time event but involves many steps over time to change social, medical, and/or legal aspects of one's life such as name, appearance, and pronouns. Transitioning can involve talking to friends, family, and coworkers, changing legal and medical documents, and/or medical intervention such as taking hormones or undergoing surgeries. It's important to understand that not everyone who transitions chooses to change their body and some people may choose to change some parts of their body but not others in order to feel comfortable within themselves.

Gender dysphoria

Gender dysphoria is a clinical diagnosis in the American Psychiatric Association's Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders (DSM) that refers to undue pain and distress experienced when a person's gender assigned at birth is different from their gender identity.

Sexual orientation

The enduring pattern of emotional, romantic, and/or sexual attraction (or lack of attraction) to other people. Sexual orientation is an inherent, unchanging attribute (i.e. not a preference or a choice.) People do change how they describe and/or understand their own sexual orientation.

Some common terms to describe Sexual orientation include

Homosexual

Describes a person who is attracted to the same gender. In some regions, "homosexual" is considered offensive due to its history as a clinical term used to marginalize LGBT people.

Asexual or ace

Not sexually attracted to anyone. Asexual folks can still have happy, healthy, romantic, and loving relationships with other people and can also be gay, bisexual, pansexual, etc.

Aromantic or aro

Not romantically attracted to anyone. As with asexual people, aromantic people can still be happy and have healthy relationships with other people.

Heterosexual/straight

Attracted to the sex/gender opposite their own on the spectrum.

Demisexual

Doesn't experience sexual attraction to someone unless they have a deep, emotional connection with them.

Gay

Attraction primarily to members of the same sex/gender. This term has historically been used for men specifically, but is often a more widely used term for both men and women.

Lesbian

Describes a woman whose sexual orientation is primarily geared towards other women.

Bisexual

Attracted to more than one gender or gender identity. Although the prefix "bi" strictly means "two", it is inaccurate to say that all bisexual people are only attracted to two genders (i.e. male and female). More commonly, people who identify as bi are attracted to multiple gender identities, including trans/non-binary identities.

Pansexual

Attracted to the person rather than their sex, gender, or gender identity. Pansexual people commonly describe their pattern of attraction as being interested in "hearts, not parts."

Queer

Often used as a term for someone who is gay, but more recently has become popular as an umbrella term for someone who identifies as anything other than straight/cisgender.

Some people also choose the labels 'queer' or 'fluid' as a way of expressing themselves by their own personal feelings.

Make sure that you use queer as an adjective and not as a noun. Good examples:

- "Amy is a queer developer."
- "Amy is queer."

But something like "Amy is a queer" is offensive.

QUILT BAG

QUILT BAG is a comprehensive, newer term that stands for queer and questioning, unsure, intersex, lesbian, transgender and two-spirit, bisexual, asexual and aromantic, and gay and genderqueer. It is a easier way to say LGBTQ+ as well as being a bit more inclusive. It was first coined in October 2006 by Sadie Lee in Diva Magazine.

Frequently Asked Questions

What's the difference between sex and gender?

Sex and gender are often seen as the same thing but in reality, sex and gender are distinct.

Sex can refer to a person's anatomy and physiology, which can include phenotype, internal and external genitalia, gonads, hormone levels, chromosomes, epigenetics, etc... Maybe people believe sex is binary (either male or female) but in reality, sex is a non-binary construct where 1 in 1500 people are born intersex.

Gender refers to the social norms, emotions, and behaviors that are associated with being female, male, androgynous, or others. Gender traits can vary greatly depending on the time period and cultural context. It's important to remember that gender is not an inherently natural thing, but rather a social construct that varies from society to society.

What's the difference between being transgender and being gay?

Transgender is a gender identity while gay is a sexual orientation. They are two different concepts. Someone can be transgender while being straight, gay, bisexual, or another sexual orientation. Similarly, someone can be gay and be cis, trans, genderqueer, or another gender identity.

What's the difference between being bisexual and pansexual?

Both gay and straight refer to sexual orientations in which a person is primarily attracted to only one gender. Bi- and pan- are sexual orientations in which a person is attracted to multiple genders. Bisexual tends to refer to attraction to multiple sexes, genders, and/or gender identities. Pansexual tends to refer to being attracted to a person, rather than their sex, gender, and/or gender identity.

This FAQ on bisexual vs pansexual orientations goes into more details.

Bi- and pan- can be very similar so it is ultimately up to the individual as to which they identify as.

What's the difference between cross-dressing and being transgender?

Cross-dressing is a specific form of gender expression that involves wearing clothing, accessories, etc. that is traditionally not associated with one's gender. Cross-dressing does not imply anything about a person's gender identity or sexual orientation.

Transgender is an umbrella term to refer to and capture all non-traditional gender identities and expressions. As such, people who cross-dress may also identify as transgender however, the distinction between being trans and cross-dressing should be noted. Cross-dressing is a temporary activity, while transgender is a state of permanence. It is best to use the term preferred by the individual.

Is being transgender a mental disorder?

No, being transgender is not a mental illness.

Transgender people can experience a mental illness known as gender dysphoria, however not all trans people have this experience, so being trans in and of itself is not a mental illness.

This Vox article on transgender mental health says it well,

> "The AMA, APA, and other medical experts agree that letting someone transition, which can entail medical treatments like hormone therapy and gender-affirming surgeries, without social stigma is the main treatment for gender dysphoria. In this way, being trans isn't the medical condition; living as trans is in fact the treatment to the medical condition."

Do all people who transition have surgery?

No, not all transgender people desire medical transition such as hormone therapy and surgeries. Additionally, some trans people do desire medical transition, but cannot afford it. They are still trans none the less.

As HRC says well,

> "Many transgender people cannot afford medical treatment nor can they access it. In light of these injustices, it is important that civil rights and protections are extended to all transgender people equally, regardless of their medical histories. It's also critical to continue advocating for full access to health care coverage for transgender people."

How do I know which pronouns to use?

Simple, just ask :)

Asking for someone's pronouns is the same as asking for their name. In the same way that you wouldn't assume what someone's name is and start calling them by a name that wasn't theirs, you shouldn't assume someone's pronouns.

In English, there are many common pronouns such as the singular they/them and ze/hir/hirs. To learn more see this [Time article](#) on pronouns.

For more information on pronouns, check out [Pronoun Guidance and Information](#).

What if I accidentally use the wrong pronouns?

Quickly apologize, correct yourself and move on. Don't make a big deal out of it. It happens.

Can someone be fired for being transgender, gay, etc.?

At GitLab, you will not get fired for any of the following reasons, no matter where you are:

Race, color, religion, national origin, sex (including pregnancy), age, disability, HIV status, sexual orientation, gender identity, marital status, past or present military service, or any other status protected by the laws or regulations in the locations where we operate.

Please review our [anti-discrimination guidelines](#) for more information on what is not tolerated at GitLab.

SECTION: people-group/paid-time-off.md

Introduction

This policy relates to the types of leaves that GitLab offers and the guidelines associated with each leave type. Training on our PTO policy is included as part of a team member's onboarding, and is also available [here](#) for reference or if a refresher is needed.

Paid Time Off

Time away from work can be extremely helpful for maintaining a healthy work/life balance. GitLab encourages managers and leadership to set the example by taking time off when needed, and ensuring their reports do the same.

Taking time off is not a selfish behavior. Not only is time away from work aligned with GitLab's operating principle [Family and friends first, work second](#), but it is vital to maintaining mental health. It is also a core part of the creative process.

It is important to take time off to recharge batteries and refresh your mind so you can come back to GitLab with renewed energy and be prepared to do your best work ever!

This page is written with a focus on vacation. The below recommendations on communicating your time off apply to time off for all reasons where possible and avoid concerns of health, safety, or job abandonment. GitLab offers a Flexible PTO Policy, but team members are not allowed to substitute PTO for sick time. If taking time off for medical needs or sick time, whether physical or mental, please follow our Sick Time Policy.

If you are taking Parental Leave, please see our Parental Leave Policy.

A GitLab Team Member's Guide to Time Off

If you are taking Parental Leave, please see our Parental Leave Policy.

Paid time off is in addition to any official public holidays that apply to the country where you live, and Friends and Family days. When accounting for time off in Workday, please use the label Public Holiday or Friends and Family. This helps us to ensure that all of our Team Members are meeting at least the Statutory Vacation Requirements.

As we all work remotely it can sometimes be difficult to know when and how to plan time off. Here is some advice and guidance on how this can be done in an easy and collaborative way. Please note that for audit and compliance purposes, all team members are required to use Workday as the single source of truth to accurately track and communicate all time off.

{{< note >}}

Entering time off in Workday is not necessary if working but working asynchronously. Instead, please follow the communicating your async work days section of the asynchronous handbook.

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1. As of 2022-05-01, we've created a Flexible PTO policy to better outline communication expectations for team members and managers. This means that:

- Our move to a Flexible PTO policy means that as long as you have coordinated with your manager about your planned time off and made a coverage plan, you are free to take PTO. There continues to be no set limit per year on the amount of PTO a team member can take.
- You are required to coordinate with your manager about your planned PTO at least twice as many days in advance as the total number of days that you plan to take off. For example, if you plan to take 3 days off, you are required to coordinate with your manager a minimum of 6 business days before. Please inform your manager of your PTO plans as soon as possible to allow for appropriate planning.
- Once you have discussed with your manager, please coordinate with your team before taking time off, especially during popular or official holidays, so that we can ensure business continuity. We want to ensure we have adequate coverage and avoid situations where all/most of the team is taking time off at the same time. Some departments have specific windows during the quarter where the team's presence is critical to accomplishing key results. Check out your departments' handbook page for more information if applicable.
- What we care about are your results, not how long you work, but we require managers to ensure that appropriate coverage is in place for their team. This requires managers to assess all PTO against team deliverables.
- Note that your manager is required to ensure that your PTO does not impact business results disproportionately and as such may request that you modify your dates when necessary.
- When asking for PTO plans to be adjusted, managers are required to specify the goal or result that may be impacted by planned PTO and share how time off may interfere with that

result or goal. Managers will be given the guidance that any requested changes they ask a team member to make need to be shared within 48 hours of the team member originally sharing their PTO plans. If there isn't a compromise that can be reached, the team member and manager should escalate to the manager's manager.

- At GitLab, team members are required to enter all days away (such as PTO, public holidays, Family & Friends Days, bereavement) in Workday. It creates an event, captures your out-of-office dates, and notifies your manager.

- If your planned leave exceeds the 25 calendar days (including weekends and holidays), please make sure to reach out to your Manager, relevant People Business Partner, and the Absence Management Team at leaves@gitlab.com for a special request. You will need additional permission if you want to take more than 25 consecutive calendar days (including weekends and holidays) off. The 25 calendar day limit is per vacation, not per year. You can have multiple vacations per year that add up to more than 25 calendar days in total; there is no limit to this.

- If you're gone for 72 hours without notification, this could be deemed as Job Abandonment.

- It can be helpful to take longer breaks to re-energize. If this is helpful to you, we strongly recommend taking at least two consecutive weeks of time off and at minimum 25 days total throughout the year.

1. We don't frown on people taking time off, but rather encourage people to take care of themselves and others by having some time away. If you notice that your co-worker is working long hours over a sustained period, you may want to let them know about the time off policy.

1. We encourage all team members to take time off for holidays observed in their country.

1. For some countries, GitLab is required to pay out unused statutory vacation balances at the end of the team members employment. To prevent any discrepancies, make sure you select the correct category for your time off (e.g. vacation).

1. Not taking time off is viewed as a weakness and people shouldn't boast about it. It is viewed as a lack of humility about your role, not fostering collaboration in training others in your job, and not being able to document and explain your work. You are doing the company a disservice by being a single point of failure. The company must be able to go for long periods without you. We don't want to lose you permanently by you burning yourself out by not taking regular time off.

1. Working hours are flexible. We encourage you to read the [whats-happening-at-gitlab](#) Slack channel on your return to catch up on the announcements made while you were on your time off.

1. You don't need to worry about taking time off to go to the gym, take a nap, go grocery shopping, do household chores, help someone, take care of a loved one, etc. If you have urgent tasks, but something comes up or takes longer than expected, just ensure the rest of the team knows and someone can pick up the tasks (assuming you're able to communicate).

1. GitLab encourages team members to volunteer within their community to take care of others. Consider taking time in support of causes that matter to you and support your personal commitment to GitLab's values such as diversity, inclusion and belonging.

1. GitLab also encourages you to use your leave for jury duty, bereavement leave, or other needs. You are not expected to work during this time off, but we recommend following the guidance under [Communicating Your Time Off](#) when these situations arise.

1. GitLab also encourages you to take time off to vote, volunteer at the polls or volunteer in your community.

1. It's important to take PTO while you have something you want to do - taking a mental health day, for example - rather than waiting until you need the time off.

- When taking PTO for a mental health day, please select the Paid Time Off label in Workday. If you'd like to add additional details, you can select Vacation from the drop down 'reason'

menu, or add comments.

1. GitLab runs as usual during regional official days off (including public or statutory holidays): we still help clients during those days, unless they are official days off in both the Netherlands and the U.S. On those days, only vital functions (such as incident remediation, emergency on-call, and customer support during GitLab Global Support Hours and US Federal Support Hours) will be staffed. If you need to work during an official day off in your country, you should take a different day off in return.

1. Please also remember to turn on your out of office message and include the contact details of a co-worker in case anything urgent or critical comes into your inbox while you're away. If you have to respond to an incident while on-call outside of your regular working hours, you should feel free to take off some time the following day to recover and be well-rested. If you feel pressured to not take time off to rest, refer to this part of the handbook and explain that you had to handle an incident.

1. If during a PTO event, you realize that certain days will need to be changed from PTO to Sick Time, or another category, log into Workday and correct the entry. Events can only be changed within 30 days of the initial request.

Holidays

We encourage all team members to take time off for public holidays observed in their country. All team members will see a public holiday accrual balance in Workday. The balance is country specific and was determined based on the local and/or contractual requirements. As a company that prides itself on a family & friends first approach no one is expected to attend calls on days they are not working or out of the office for an official public holiday. As a company that values Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging, public holidays will not be pre-loaded to Workday, instead team members have the flexibility to elect different dates and celebrate what's important to them, as long as they do not exceed the balance in Workday.

For a general list of public holidays by country, follow these steps:

1. Go to the timeanddate.com
2. Select 'Holidays Worldwide' from the Calendar dropdown menu.
3. Select your country of residence
4. Change the dropdown from 'All holidays and national observances' to 'Public Holidays'

For any questions related to holidays or how to categorize time off please reach out using HelpLab. Please note that Public Holidays will be listed in Workday with a length of 1 day.

Communicating Your Time Off

Communicate broadly when you will be away so other people can manage time efficiently, projects don't slip through the cracks, and so that you don't get bothered while away.

1. Please use the following syntax which uses the ISO 8601 date notation in order to avoid confusion: OOO from YYYY-MM-DD to YYYY-MM-DD, please contact XXX for assistance.

- Workday will automatically add this time to Time Off by Deel and as a busy event on your Google Calendar. Your manager will also receive a free event on their calendar.

- When your time off starts, Time off by Deel will automatically update your Slack status to communicate your time off. This will prevent you from appearing in reviewer roulette.

1. As outlined above, it's expected that you provide your manager and team members who may

expect to work with you with as much advanced notice as possible about your planned time off. You should give other team members advanced notice that is at least twice as many days as the time that you plan to take off. For example, if you plan to take 3 days off, you should let other team members know at least 6 business days before.

1. Add an out of office automated response including the dates you plan to be away in your automated response.

1. Consider using Google Calendar's "out of office" setting (scroll down to "Show when you're out of office") to create an out of office event that will automatically decline new and existing meetings for you.

1. If you plan to be out of the office for more than 48 hours, update your GitLab.com status with your out of office dates by clicking on your profile picture and selecting "Edit Status."

For Example: 'OOO Back on 2018-06-28.' Don't forget to change it back upon your return, and be aware that this information is publicly accessible.

- In order to be skipped by reviewer roulette, you must have either a Slack status or a GitLab.com status indicating that you are out (the exact criteria can be found on the reviewer roulette docs page).

1. If your team or work group has a specific scheduling calendar, ensure to update it with your out of office plans.

1. Decline any meetings you will not be present for so the organizer can make appropriate arrangements.

- Cancel, move, or find coverage for any meetings for which you are the organizer.

- Optionally, if you partake in Donut coffee chat pairings you can temporarily "snooze" them by opening a direct message with Donut and typing help to indicate which weeks you won't be able to participate. Pairings will automatically resume when you're back.

1. If you are an interviewer, review your calendar to address any scheduled interviews. To ensure we provide a great candidate experience, if you find that you cannot attend an interview, you will be responsible for finding a replacement interviewer. You must communicate directly with your recruiter, as being out of the office does not always mean that you will be unavailable to interview.

1. If you're one of the people who typically handle availability emergencies (the on-call heroes), you do need to ensure that someone will be available to cover for you while you're out of office. You can check for this with your manager. Managers can import their team's calendars into their Google Calendar to get a quick view of their team members' availability.

1. Being part of a global remote team means you need to be highly organized and a considerate team player. Each team has busy times so it is always a good idea to check with them to ensure there is adequate coverage in place.

1. In case an emergency arises while you're away, please designate a backup individual and brief them on your key projects so they can assist in your absence.

1. Transition and reassign work that is already in progress to another member of your team whenever possible.

1. Please document your knowledge and share it with others. Key-person-risk can have a large impact. This is especially true for "subject matter experts" or SME, people with specialized knowledge of a project, tool, or subject.

1. It can be very helpful for your PTO and team members if you document, share (weekly team call + async in Slack) and communicate your PTO already well in advance (2-3 weeks).

1. One useful way of capturing work is to create & share a Google Doc which lists all your important projects / customer interactions + a short list of useful details per entry. This include tips for covering you best while on PTO. For example:

1. "Name of covering team member" - also useful for your manager to quickly know who is covering which projects or customers for you.

1. "Attendance in calls/zoom sessions required while on PTO" - Teammates can already start to plan and free up time in their calendar for specified dates/times.

1. "High Priority Topics" - List of topics and/or links to issues which are most relevant while you are on PTO.

1. "Comments by covering team member" - Very useful to asynchronously get updates quickly when you return from your PTO.

1. Pro tip: Use color codes (e.g. green, red) and symbols (e.g. ·, ···) to let others easily & quickly identify most important entries.

- Please don't use colors only as people with color blindness may not be able to distinguish between them

1. It may be useful to share your planned time off as an FYI on your team's Slack channel(s); especially if you lead a team. You can schedule messages in Slack to remind your team of items that are due or projects that are pending while you are off. Here are some examples of reminders that could be scheduled:

- > Hey team, just a reminder that I'm out today. Please take a look at my open tickets. Thanks!

- > Hello team, I am out of the office for the next several days. Please double check the pending tasks on our team's Google Doc for any upcoming deadlines.

1. Please see the On-Call page for information on how to handle scheduled leave for someone from the On-Call team.

1. If you are a people manager, please complete the following:

- Workday: set up a delegate in Workday to be able to approve transactions on your behalf while you are away

- Navan Expense: delegate expense approval to your back-up team member by following these steps:

- Navan Expense

- Settings

- Your Account

- Vacation Delegate - enter their email address and Payroll will grant the backup team member the necessary access

- Note - remove the vacation delegate after your PTO

Communicating Time Off for Emergency Situations

Emergencies, by definition, are unexpected. They can range from natural disasters, terrorist events, accidents, family deaths, hospitalization and any other unexpected situation. During these times we ask team members to use their best judgement as well as listen to and adhere to public safety officials when possible. If an unexpected emergency occurs please contact your manager via Slack or email as soon as possible if you will be unavailable or unable to work. This will allow your manager to confirm your safety and reassign any critical work during your absence. Please make sure you've added at least one emergency contact in Workday. We will only contact your emergency contact if we are unable to reach you via Slack, email or phone. We also recommend that if you are able, to use the Public Emergency OOO category in Workday.

Returning from PTO

Returning from PTO of any length can feel overwhelming. Consider implementing these strategies when returning from time off in order to make the most of the rest and reflection you've achieved.

1. Remember that it's normal to take extra time to catch up after returning from paid time off. Taking time off doesn't mean that you need to work extra hours before or after your vacation. When taking extended time off, expect to have reduced capacity to take on new work the week of your return while you're catching up on the work that happened while you were away. Remember that it's impossible to know everything.

1. Honor a window of transition when returning from PTO and recognize that rest and time off is productive. Big, reflective moments may happen when you take a step back and reflect. Before catching up on all missed emails and Slack messages, consider first revisiting priority projects to take action on these reflections. In our interview about managing burnout, John Fitch described this approach as spending time working on your projects, rather than in your projects. This could look like blocking off a few days with no meetings to complete deep work on an OKR or hosting a collaborative session with your team to brainstorm.

1. When returning from paid time off, it can be helpful to schedule a coffee chat or two on the day of your return to get caught up, share stories from your time off, and simply reconnect with your team members. It also provides a nice break from to-dos and unread emails. This type of conversation may occur organically in a colocated office but needs to be managed with intent in an all-remote company.

Sick Time - Taking and Reporting

Sick time refers to the time away a team member needs to recover from short-term (non-chronic, or reoccurring) illness such as but not limited to COVID-19, menstrual pain, cold/flu, surgery, care for a close family member recovering from illness, or for preventative reasons like a doctor's appointment. Eligible family members includes but may not be limited to: parent(s), child(ren), spouse, domestic partner, grandparent(s), grandchild(ren), or sibling(s).

In keeping with our values of CREDIT, we have crafted the following protocols around GitLab's global sick time policy available to all GitLab team members. Team members may be eligible for their own country's Sick Time Policies and should review eligibility under these policies as they may offer more time away or have different reporting procedures. We understand team members experience situations when they need continuous time away from work (5 days or more) to care for themselves or a family member, or situations when they just need a few days (less than 5), GitLab's Sick Time policy is applicable in both situations.

Sick time does not get paid out in case of termination, nor does it reduce your final paycheck in case of a negative balance.

Sick Time Reporting Procedures - All Team Members

Team members in France, Netherlands, and U.S, please read specific reporting procedures below.

All team members, regardless of the duration of sick time, are required to notify GitLab of their absence. Team members must notify their Manager, first, and then enter the time away in Workday by selecting the label Out Sick. If your sick time extends beyond 5 days, or less per your country's statutory sick time reporting requirements, team members are required to notify the Absence Management Team (leaves@gitlab.com) first, and then enter the time away into Workday.

Continuous Time Away (in excess of 5 days or more), or Non-Continuous if related to the same illness:

Whenever allowed by law, GitLab's Sick Time Policy will supplement a team member's pay up to 100% of their regular salary for up to 25 working days of continuous absences, and run concurrently with any statutory Sick Leave policies team members are eligible for. Eligibility is calculated on a rolling 12-month period, and only pertains to absences when team members need to be away from work for 5 or more continuous days or non-continuous if related to the same illness.

We understand some team members may need additional time away to care for a sick family member, but many countries do not offer statutory family care leave and/or pay when needing to care for a sick family member. If a team member is not eligible for statutory family care leave or pay in their country, GitLab will provide an additional 25 working days of sick time to care for their family member. This means, a team member in a country that does not provide statutory family care leave and/or pay is eligible to receive 25 working days of sick leave for their own condition, plus an additional 25 working days of sick leave to care for an ill family member. Eligibility is contingent on providing evidence, in accordance with local requirements, supporting the need for Sick Leave to care for their ill family member. (see medical certificate/doctor's note below for more information)

Non-Continuous Absences or absences less than 5 continuous days:

If you or a loved one is ill, we want you to take care of yourself or your loved one(s). To facilitate this, you should take sick time when you need it, but you still need to report when you take sick time by notifying GitLab first and then entering the dates in Workday by selecting the label Out Sick.

- Once entered in Workday, your sick time will be automatically updated in Time Off by Deel.

If you end up more than 5 consecutive calendar days, or 5 non-continuous calendar days related to the same illness, please follow the instructions in the Communicating Illness-Related Leave section.

Sick Time Procedures - USA

In the United States, team members may experience a qualifying condition under the Family Medical Leave Act (FMLA) after 3 days of continuous or non-continuous absences (if related to the same condition). If you are missing more than 3 calendar days of work due to a serious medical condition or to care for a family member with a serious medical condition, your time away will be reviewed to determine if it qualifies as leave under the Family Medical Leave Act (FMLA) and/or any concurrent state sick leave statutes. Team Members are required to notify the Absence Management Team [leaves@gitlab.com] no later than the 5th consecutive/non-consecutive absence, so that the time away can be processed under the applicable leave laws, but may notify the Absence Management Team as of the 3 consecutive/non-consecutive day.

- Please be aware that certain states in the US require you to notify your employer of the need for a medical leave prior to your first day of leave whenever possible. To ensure timely reporting and prevent any delays in your pay, please follow the instructions listed in the Family Medical Leave Act handbook section to report your time away.

- Sick Pay will be coordinated with Short-Term Disability, and/or the equivalent State pay benefits.

Sick Time Procedures - Netherlands

Employees of GitLab B.V. have further rights and responsibilities regarding sick time based on Dutch law, as written into their employment contracts:

- Team members must notify their manager of any sick leave needed.
- Team members must then enter the sick time via Workday as aligned above.
- If the sick leave extends 8 days it should be reported to the Absence Management team via leaves@gitlab.com by the Manager and team member (if able).
- If team members are reporting multiple instances of sick leave in a 28 day timeframe, please reach out to the Absence Management team.
- Once the Absence Management team has been notified of the sick time they will inform HRSavvy.
- HRSavvy will be registering the sick time in their HR portal from the first day of absence (retrospectively).
- GitLab has engaged with an occupational health and safety centre, called Leuk Personeel, to assist employees of GitLab B.V. who may need support while being on long-term sick leave.
- If the team members is on long-term sick leave (8 days of more), the Absence Management team will instruct HRSavvy to register the team member at the occupational health and safety service, depending on the situation and agreement with the team member.

Sick Time Procedures - France

See the France S.A.S. benefits page.

Medical Certificate/Doctor's Note

Please be aware that certain countries require a medical certificate, doctor's note or similar type of documentation for your sick time. Please review your employment contract or your country's Sick Time policy to determine what documentation may be needed.

Eligibility for GitLab's Sick Time policy will require team members to provide evidence, in accordance with local requirements, supporting the need for Sick Leave.

Team Members should email the documentation to Absence Management team (leaves@gitlab.com).

Communicating Illness-Related Leave

In the unfortunate event that a team member is dealing with a medical situation, they are under no obligation to reveal details to their manager directly. Instead, you can reach out to the Absence Management Team leaves@gitlab.com. The Absence Management Team will inform the People Business Partner and Manager on a need-to-know basis, but will only provide details related to leave dates; not illness. If the manager does become aware of the team members illness, the manager should under no circumstances reveal any illness-related leave to other team members to ensure we respect the privacy of the team member affected.

Accommodations

GitLab (The Company) complies with all applicable laws, which make it unlawful to discriminate in employment against a qualified individual with a disability. If you believe you need reasonable accommodation, please follow the process outlined on this handbook page.

Communicating with team members while they are leave of absence

For team members who are on paid or unpaid leave of absence like parental leave, short or long-term disability, or other approved leaves there is no expectation that work would be accomplished during this time. Team members should use their approved paid or unpaid leave as an opportunity to focus on their health and well being. For managers it is important that you do not reach out to team members and ask them to complete work while on an approved leave of absence. An occasional quick call for a simple question is acceptable but these should be infrequent and simple requests that can be answered during that conversation.

We do understand that during extended periods of time off team members may still want to feel connected. We encourage team members at their discretion to maintain a social connection with their peers and team members. This is completely up to the team member on leave on how or if they want to remain connected while on leave of absence.

For managers it is ok to reach out to a team member every 3-4 weeks to just to say hello. These conversations should remain social and avoid work related topics.

Workday

All team members and Managers, including those employed under a PEO, are expected to log all time away requests into Workday (Vacation, Public Holiday, Friends & Family, Sick Time, etc.)

As of October 1, 2024, Workday and Workday Slack will be the primary point of entry for all time away needs. This allows team members and managers to coordinate time off seamlessly. The integration between Workday and Time Off by Deel will still be available, but all data will feed from Workday into Time Off by Deel; retaining Deel's functionality (reminds employees of their upcoming time off, assign roles and tasks for co-workers, Google Calendar synchronization, and automatic OOO updates).

GitLab team member questions about Workday can be directed to the HelpLab portal.

Workday to Time Off by Deel Synchronization

Google Calendar Sync

Workday time away entries will flow into Time Off by Deel allowing you to sync time off requests with your Google Calendar.

A calendar invite will also be sent to your manager to help them keep track of their team's time away. This event will always be based on the calendar date and will not adjust for timezones. If you are a manager with team members in varying timezones, you may end up with calendar invites that do not accurately reflect the actual time away. As a manager, you can simply decline the calendar invite and manually create a correct entry on your own calendar without affecting the actual time off request.

More information regarding this sync can be found on the [Team PTO Calendar handbook page](#).

Automatic Status + Do Not Disturb Updates

Time Off by Deel can automatically set your OOO status in Slack and apply "Do Not Disturb" settings while you're away. You must add these permissions individually.

Roles and Task Handoffs

Time off by Deel provides an experience that allows you to set roles and tasks for co-workers while you're away. Accepted roles then become a part of a Slack away message that appears as co-workers try to tag you in discussions while you're OOO.

Before assigning a channel to a role, please ask for permission to do so in that channel. Especially in large channels and during popular vacation times, PTO's role reminders could create a lot of noise, so some teams may recommend against them until there is an option to allow turning off the PTO notifications.

Monthly reminder to consider taking PTO

We get it - life gets busy. So busy, in fact, that you may need a little nudge to consider taking time off to recharge. Time off by Deel allows you to subscribe (and unsubscribe) to a monthly prompt, sent on the first working day of each month, reminding you to pause and think about time away from work and prioritizing mental health.

The reminder will read as follows.

> Hi there! Have you thought about what days you may take off this month? ... We want to make sure you stay healthy! If you feel like you can't reasonably take time off, feel welcome to add this note to your next 1:1 with your manager and discuss further. Learn more about paid time off at [GitLab: /handbook/people-group/paid-time-off/](#)

To subscribe or unsubscribe, follow the below instructions and see an associated screenshot.

- Visit Apps in the menu bar within Slack and search for or select Time Off by Deel
- On the application's Home tab, select Notifications from the dropdown
- Beneath the dropdown, you'll see a line that says "Send me a monthly reminder about taking time off." Click the Subscribe button to trigger the notification, which will begin on the first working day (e.g. not a weekend or a public holiday) in the month following your subscription.
- To unsubscribe, revisit the app and click the button that says Unsubscribe.

Checking "Who's Out?"

Considering GitLab has a flexible time off policy, it is helpful to know who else on your team is out of office prior to requesting time. In order to see who is out of your team, follow the steps below:

- Go to the Time off by Deel application in Slack

- In the Home section, select Who's Out? from the dropdown list
- Click new search to view who is out by channel, @usergroup, or @username

Requesting and documenting new Workday features

You can request a new Workday feature by using the aforementioned /time-off-deel feedback command in Slack. If you receive feedback from the Workday team, or a new feature is implemented, please document the discussion in this GitLab issue. You can also create an issue in the People Group general project and ping CEO Kevin Corliss @pto-ninja and CTO Doug Franklin @doug17 for review.

Instructions for Team Members to update past events

Team members can correct or edit future and, past-dated time off entries up to 30 days in the past. All other entries will need to be submitted to the People Connect team for review using HelpLab. Not all requests will be approved as it is the team member's responsibility to assure all time away requests are accurate.

Management's Role in Paid Time Off

Managers have a duty to manage their direct reports well-being and ensure that time off is being taken. Sometimes, when working remotely from home, it can be hard to find a good work-life balance. It is also easy to forget that your team is working across multiple time zones, so some may feel obligated to work longer to ensure there is overlap. It is important that you check-in with your reports through one-to-ones, and if you think someone needs some time off, let them know they can do this.

For audit and compliance purposes, managers are responsible for ensuring that their team members track and communicate all time off using Workday as the single source of truth. Whether a team member is taking one day off, or 25+ calendar days off, all team members must use Workday.

For audit and compliance purposes, managers have a responsibility to be aware of their direct reports' statutory time off policies, as applicable in countries in which GitLab is the employer. Some countries require employers to ensure team members are taking time off, so it is recommended that managers review their direct reports' OOO time frequently, using the reports described in the section below. Managers do not need to understand the ins and outs of the policies; just that team member in specific country receives certain amount of days/year. The specifics of these policies (accrual maximums, rollover, accrual rates, etc) will still be managed within the People Ops team. Please feel free to reach out to leaves@gitlab.com with any questions.

If you discover that multiple people in your team want to be off at the same time, see what the priorities are, review the impact to the business, and use your best judgement. Discuss this with your team so you can manage the time off together. It is also a good idea to remind your team to give everyone an early heads-up, if possible, about upcoming vacation plans. Reminders can be sent in Slack, shared on a team calendar, or noted during team meetings.

If as a manager you are notified that your direct report has been incapacitated or unable to submit an OOO request in Workday and needs to take time off, be it Sick Time or otherwise,

please document this information, and relay it to the Absence Management Team via leaves@gitlab.com without disclosing private medical information in compliance with applicable privacy laws. The Absence Management Team will submit an OOO request on the team members behalf and mark the reason as Per Manager Name, and save the email thread in the team members profile in Workday. This documentation will be unshared and will not contain any personal medical information.

Workday Manager Reporting

Reporting from Workday helps managers:

1. Be sure their direct reports are taking enough PTO
1. Review upcoming PTO of direct reports to make project management decisions and manage team member burnout

Managers will have access to Time Away dashboards and other reports within Workday.

How to use Workday data to support your team

Understanding the PTO that teams have taken, and plan to take, helps managers have conversations about burnout and burnout management with their direct reports. Below are common scenarios faced by managers that can be supported using Workday data.

Planning and decision making for future projects

1. Review time away data planned for the upcoming quarter
1. Use planned PTO to make decisions including
 - What does my team have capacity to achieve this quarter?
 - What weeks should I avoid scheduling key communication or planning?
 - What weeks are best to have synchronous team calls?
 - What weeks do I plan to take off, and how do those overlap with my team?
1. If your team does not have any planned PTO, consider sending a message or encouraging them in your next 1:1 to plan ahead to take PTO. Getting ahead of burnout is important and can be partially addressed with adequate rest.
1. Confirm that you're getting calendar invitations for your direct reports PTO.

Supporting Team Members Taking Time Off

Taking time off should be a chance for a team members to step away from work and we need each other's help to make that easier. PTO should not encourage people to cram work in before they leave or work extra hard upon their return in order to catch up.

1. Before a team member goes on leave, avoid the temptation to ask them to work on a few more things.
1. Tell fellow team members that you are expecting them not to check in while they are on PTO.
1. Minimize emails and mentions to team members who are on PTO, unless it's critical that they know something when they return. Try to keep their inbox empty.
1. Welcome team members back to work and do not ask them work questions until they are ready.

Recognizing Burnout

It is important for us to take a step back to recognize and acknowledge the feeling of being "burned out".

We are not as effective or efficient when we work long hours, miss meals or forego nurturing our personal lives for sustained periods of time. If you feel that you or someone on your team may be experiencing burnout, be sure to address it right away.

To get ahead of a problem, be sure to communicate with your manager if any of the following statements ever apply to you:

- "I am losing interest in social interaction." - This is especially dangerous in an all-remote setting.
- "I've lost the motivation to work." - Everyone has days when they don't want to work but if you hear yourself saying this often, you're on the road to burnout.
- "I often feel tired." - Indicative of being overworked for prolonged periods of time.
- "I get agitated easily."
- "I've been hostile to my coworkers." - You see yourself "snap" at people for no apparent reason.
- "I've been having headaches often." - A headache can manifest itself for multiple reasons but if you catch yourself only having headaches on work days, it is time to evaluate your situation.

These and similar symptoms might get missed or dismissed, as people who are on the path to burnout, or who are burnt out, are usually unable to spend the mental energy to recognize it in themselves. Having an external source objectively identify the situation can be helpful. A great tool for objectively recognizing burn out is burnoutindex.org.

If someone is showing signs of burnout, they should take time off to focus on things that are relaxing and improve their overall health and welfare.

As a manager, it is your task to evaluate your team's state of mind.

Address possible burnout by discussing options with your team member to manage contributing stressors and evaluate the workload.

Some things to help with this:

- Try to follow each of your team members' work habits. If they start being less efficient, or working more hours, they might be on the road to burnout.
- Try to keep track of when they had their last paid day off. If they hadn't had a personal day in a long time, look closer at their behavior.
- Make sure you let your team members know they can talk to you about their challenges.
- When you recognize symptoms of burnout in others, help them to get out the "Burnout trap".

Don't just tell people to take a break,

but help them arrange things so they can take a break. Ask why they feel they can't take a break

(there are almost certainly real, concrete reasons) and then ask permission to get busy putting things in place

that will overcome those barriers. People might be trapped by their own fatigue, being too worn out to find the creative solutions needed to take a break.

Other tips to avoid burnout include:

- Make use of our Employee Assistance Program that can offer professional support during this time.
- Assess and pursue your interests, skills and passions.
- Take breaks during the day to eat healthy food and stretch your legs. The Timeout app can help with that.
- Make time each day to increase blood and oxygen circulation which improves brain activity and functionality.
- Get plenty of restful sleep.
- Meditate to take your mind away from work. Headspace and Calm are good tools for creating meditation habits.
- Don't start work as soon as you wake up. Take your time doing your morning routine.
- Set yourself away when you are not working. Snooze your Slack notifications. It is fine to be not reachable during your off time.

Don't let burnout creep up on you. Working remotely can allow us to create bad habits, such as working straight through lunch to get something finished. Once in a while this feels good, perhaps to check that nagging task or big project off the list, but don't let this become a bad habit. Before long, you'll begin to feel the effects on your body and see it in your work.

Keep in mind that you are not alone! Chances are that you have a colleague who already experienced burnout or has been on the road to burnout. Schedule coffee calls with your team members or with anyone you'd like to talk to. Talk to your manager. If none of that is an option for you, schedule a coffee call with Marin.

Take care not to burn yourself out!

Statutory Vacation Requirements

The following is a list of all statutory annual vacation entitlements by entity and country. Once the statutory amounts have been taken, team members can still make use of GitLab's Flexible time off policy.

GitLab LTD (UK)

Team members are entitled to at least 28 vacation days, this is broken down by 20 days standard annual leave plus 8 public holidays. These days will accrue from the start date at a rate of 1.67 days/month. It is important for UK team members to utilise time off for public holidays as the total amount of annual leave is accrued here inclusive of public holidays. Under normal circumstances, there is no carryover for unused vacation days. However, given the situation surrounding COVID-19 team members may be eligible to carry over unused vacation days if team members have a COVID-related reason that prevented them from being able to utilize vacation. UK government announcement.

GitLab BV (Netherlands)

Team members are entitled to at least 20 statutory vacation days per calendar year. The days will accrue at 1.67 days/month from the team members start date. Any unused statutory vacation days will be carried into the next calendar year, but expire on July 1st. Should the team

member leave GitLab within the calendar year, an entitlement to a pro rata portion of vacation days exists.

GitLab BV (Finland)

Team members with less than 1 year of tenure are entitled to 2 days/month totaling 2 weeks per year. Team members with 1 year or more of tenure are entitled to 2.5 day/month totaling 30 days per year. Team members are allowed to carry over up to 24 workdays into the next calendar year, but expire 1 year from the accrual on April 1st.

GitLab BV (Belgium)

Team members are entitled to at least 20 vacation days/year. These days will be front-loaded at the beginning of each year. The days taken must be communicated to the Belgian payroll provider each month by People Ops. These days do not carry over into the next calendar year.

GitLab IT BV (Contractors)

Contractors do not have statutory vacation requirements, but are eligible for our Flexible Time Off Policy.

GitLab GmbH (Germany)

Team members are entitled to at least 20 vacation days. The days will accrue from the start date at a rate of 1.67 days/month. In general, team members must take their annual vacation days during the calendar year, otherwise it is forfeited. However, unused vacation days can be carried forward until the 31st of March of the next calendar year if the employee was unable to take the holiday due to operational or personal reasons.

GitLab PTY (Australia & New Zealand)

Team members are entitled to a minimum of four weeks' annual holidays per year. Annual leave does not expire and can be carried over each year.

New Zealand Only: GitLab may set expectations on how much annual leave team members may accumulate and may require team members to take entitled leave with 14 days notice.

GitLab GK (Japan)

An employee who has been continuously employed for six months and whose attendance has been at least 80% of the total number of working days during that period, is entitled to a minimum of ten days' annual paid leave on the day after completing six months of employment. The entitlement increases by one day per year for the following two years and by two days per year thereafter, up to a maximum of 20 days per year. Unused annual paid leave expires after two years if not used. Companies are not required to purchase out unused annual paid leave when team members leave companies unless otherwise provided in the work rules or employment contracts.

GitLab Inc. (USA)

The U.S. Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) does not require payment for time not worked, such as vacations, sick leave or federal or other holidays.

GitLab Ireland

Team members are entitled to accrue 20 days per year at a rate of 1.67 days/month from the team member's start date. The holiday year will run from January 1st to December 31st of each year. Unused vacation days cannot ordinarily be carried forward into the following holiday year, however, if the team member is unable to take vacation due to long-term sick leave, then unused vacation days can be carried forward for up to 15 months from the end of the relevant holiday year.

GitLab Korea Limited

- Team members with 0-1 year of service are entitled to 1 day/month or 12 days/year.
- Team members with 1-3 years of service are entitled to 1.25 days/month or 15 days/year.
- Team members with 3+ years of service are entitled to one additional day for every two years continuously worked up to 25 days/year.
- Accrual balances reset January 1st of every year.

GitLab PTE Ltd. (Singapore)

- After 3 months of employment, accrual rates will be based on tenure. Team members are allowed to carry over unused vacation up to the statutory accrual limit based on tenure.
- 1 year of service: 7 days/year
- 2 years of service: 8 days/year
- 3 years of service: 9 days/year
- 4 years of service: 10 days/year
- 5 years of service: 11 days/year
- 6 years of service: 12 days/year
- 7 years of service: 13 days/year
- 8 years of service: 14 days/year

GitLab S.A.S (France)

Team members are entitled to a minimum of 5 weeks of statutory vacation per year. The accrual period in France is June 1st - May 31st and accruals are prorated based on the number of months worked in the accrual period. Any unused statutory vacation days will be carried into the next accrual period, but expire one year after it's accrued.

Reduction of working time (RTT)

- Certain roles within GitLab may benefit from reduced working time (RTT), and the accrual period for RTT days is January 1st - December 31st each year.
 - Team members cannot carry RTT days to the following year and we encourage all team members to use RTT accruals within the year.
- Team members are encouraged to review additional information on working time in France and RTT calculation.

GitLab Canada Corp (Canada)

GitLab's PTO policy overrides over GitLab Canada Corp in the sense that the policies listed here are stating the statutory minimum that each GitLab Canada Corp team member must take to be compliant with relevant provincial laws. For more information, refer to the applicable employment standards legislation of the Province in which you reside.

- Alberta Employment Standards
- British Columbia Employment Standards
- Manitoba Employment Standards
- New Brunswick Employment Standards
- Newfoundland and Labrador Labor Standards
- Northwest Territories Employment Standards
- Nova Scotia Labor Standards
- Nunavut Labor Standards
- Ontario Employment Standards
- Prince Edward Island Employment Standards
- Quebec Labor Standards
- Saskatchewan Employment Standards
- Yukon Employment Standards
- In most provinces in Canada, team members are entitled to Vacation time after they have worked for 12 consecutive months.
- Vacation pay is calculated as a percentage of the gross wages an employee earns during a "year of employment". Vacation pay is earned the moment employment begins (except in Newfoundland and Labrador and British Columbia which starts accruing after 5 calendar days). "Gross wages" include: base salary, hourly wages (if applicable), and commission or other incentive-based pay. It does not include discretionary bonuses that are not related to hours, production or efficiency.
- Vacation pay in respect of any earned but unused vacation time must be paid out on termination.
- GitLab Canada Corp should ensure that all statutory mandatory minimum vacation time is taken within 12 months of it being earned.

Policy Locations	Statutory Minimum Vacation Time	Statutory Minimum Vacation Pay
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All of Canada (except SK, QC, ON)	2 weeks after 1 year / 3 weeks after 5 years	4% for the first 5 years, 6% after 5 years
Quebec Only	Less than 1 year - 1 day per full month of uninterrupted service, not to exceed 2 weeks; 1 year to less than 3 years - 2 consecutive weeks; 3 years or more - 3 consecutive weeks	4% for first 3 years; 6% after 3 years
Saskatchewan Only	3 weeks after 1 year / 4 weeks after 10 years	6% for the first 9 years, 8% after 9 years
Ontario Only	2 weeks after 1 year / 3 weeks after 4 years	4% for the first 5 years, 6% after 5 years

SECTION: people-group/people-group-program-management.md

Overview

Program Managers keep our division aligned on what success looks like, how to measure it, and what steps are required to achieve our goals. Through effective management of programs and projects, this group keeps us on track, organized, and driving towards our most impactful business results. By staying closely connected, this function supports our ability to remain agile, iterative, and connected through cross-functional and team-specific projects.

We have various Program Management roles across GitLab. Within the People Group, Program Managers report directly to the team they support to ensure they are as close as possible to their core areas of responsibility, team, and focus.

The goals of this page are to:

- Generate more awareness around Program Manager roles in the People Group
- Create consistent Program Management practices within the People Group
- Drive further cross-departmental connection, alignment, and awareness
- Facilitate internal networking for learning and connection amongst individuals in these roles
- Provide a space for knowledge-sharing and learning

Key Competencies

Regardless of the team, our Program Management key competencies are consistent to ensure the function at its core remains aligned. While the job families remain the SSOT for roles across GitLab, a few key competencies and behaviors to expect from all Program Managers within the People Group are:

| Key Competency | Behavior |

| ----- | ----- |

| Subject matter expertise | Guides and oversees programs and projects within their functional area of expertise. |

| Effective communication | Provides regular project status updates to stakeholders through effective communication; maps team projects and the status of various projects for stakeholder visibility. |

| Growth mindset | Ensure we remain iterative and continue to grow and improve (e.g. facilitate retrospectives, and optimize where possible). |

| Change management | Supports change management when needed and can quickly facilitate or pivot changes in schedule or timeline. |

| Stakeholder management | Keeps project teams and stakeholders aligned and accountable for executing deliverables. |

| Strategic planning | Ensures work aligns with the division's and organization's overall goals. |

| Program management methodologies | Research, discovery, and documentation of current state processes and workflow. Creates and maintains the project plan in collaboration with team members and helps identify, mitigate, and escalate risks and issues. |

Note: Company-wide competencies can be referenced here and company-wide job frameworks can be referenced here. The competencies outlined above are intended to complement these existing artifacts, not replace them.

Roles

We have Program Management roles on several teams across the People Group.

While the core competencies remain across all of the roles, we have separate job families across functions to ensure that the niche experience or focus required to be successful in specific areas of our division is captured.

Role overviews, responsibilities, requirements, and performance indicators can be reviewed on the team-specific job family pages below.

- People Operations Program Manager
 - Key Ongoing Programs: Quarterly intake and program management of HR systems, tools, and technologies (i.e. Workday)
- Global Wo